

WE'VE DISCOVERED THE SECRET OF LIFE

THE ROLE OF DNA

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURES

Francis Crick (1916–2004), **Rosalind Franklin** (1920–58), **James Watson** (1928–), **Maurice Wilkins** (1916–2004)

BEFORE

1910–29 US biochemist Phoebus Levene describes the chemical components of DNA.

1944 US researchers Oswald Avery, Colin Macleod, and Maclyn McCarty show that DNA determines inheritance.

AFTER

1987 "Environmental DNA" (eDNA) is first used to describe DNA that is collected from an environment (such as water or soil) rather than an organism.

1990 British researchers, led by embryologist Ian Wilmut, successfully clone an adult mammal—Dolly the sheep.

2021 Scientists complete the sequencing of the nuclear genome of 3,278 animal species.